

L002: Telephone Triage: Urgent vs. Non-Urgent

Free Practice Sheet | @ondutyenglish | oabuilds.io/practice/L002

Lane B — Medical English

Section 1 — Key Vocabulary

1. triage

/ˈtriːɑːʒ/ noun/verb

The process of sorting patients by urgency of their medical need.

"The triage nurse assessed the patient's condition before calling the doctor."

Tagalog: pag-uuri ng mga pasyente ayon sa pangangailangan

2. onset

/ˈɒnset/ noun

The beginning or start of a symptom or condition.

"When was the onset of your chest pain?"

Tagalog: simula ng sintomas

3. severity

/sɪˈvɛrɪti/ noun

The degree of seriousness of a symptom or condition.

"Can you rate the severity of your pain on a scale of one to ten?"

Tagalog: kalubhaan

4. radiating

/ˈreɪdiɪtɪŋ/ adjective

Spreading outward from a central point (used for pain).

"Is the pain radiating to your arm or jaw?"

Tagalog: kumakalat na sakit

On Duty English

5. associated symptoms

/ə'səʊsi.eɪtɪd 'sɪmptəmz/ noun phrase

Other symptoms that occur alongside the main complaint.

"Are there any associated symptoms such as nausea or dizziness?"

Tagalog: kasamang mga sintomas

6. dispatch

/dɪ'spætʃ/ verb

To send emergency services to a location.

"I'm going to dispatch an ambulance to your address immediately."

Tagalog: magpadala ng tulong

7. contraindication

/ˌkɒntrəˌɪndɪˈkeɪʃən/ noun

A condition that makes a particular treatment inadvisable.

"Aspirin is contraindicated if the patient has a known allergy."

Tagalog: kontraindikasyon

8. protocol

/'prɒtəkɒl/ noun

A set of official rules or procedures to be followed.

"We follow the triage protocol for all incoming calls."

Tagalog: protokol / pamamaraan

Section 2 — Phrases & Patterns

Can you describe your symptoms?

Open-ended triage opener.

"Can you describe your symptoms and when they started?"

On a scale of one to ten...

Assess pain severity.

"On a scale of one to ten, how would you rate your pain?"

I'm going to connect you with...

Transfer or escalate.

"I'm going to connect you with the on-call physician right away."

On Duty English

Please stay on the line.

Keep caller engaged during escalation.

"Please stay on the line while I contact emergency services."

Section 3 — Scenario Practice

Read the dialogue aloud. Circle any words you found difficult to pronounce.

Triage Nurse: Good afternoon, NHS 111. How can I help you today?

Caller: Hello, I've been having chest pain for about twenty minutes.

Triage Nurse: I understand. Can you describe the pain? Is it sharp, dull, or pressure-like?

Caller: It feels like pressure. And it's radiating to my left arm.

Triage Nurse: On a scale of one to ten, how would you rate the severity?

Caller: About a seven. I'm also feeling nauseous.

Triage Nurse: I'm dispatching an ambulance to your location now. Please stay on the line and do not eat or drink anything.

Section 4 — Self-Evaluation

After completing the exercises, tick each item you feel confident about:

I can ask about onset, severity, and associated symptoms in English.

I can use 'radiating', 'contraindication', and 'protocol' correctly.

I can escalate a call using professional English phrases.

I can explain triage urgency levels to a patient.

Section 5 — My Notes

This worksheet is for English language education purposes only. It does not constitute medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment.

Lessons developed using AI-assisted production with reviewed industry vocabulary sources. © On Duty English | @ondutyenglish | oabuilds.io